Prince Mathew

Postdoctoral Researcher
Computer Science Department
Université Libre de Bruxelles

+32 472 49 71 20
prince.mathew@ulb.be
0000-0001-6410-1474
princemathew07

Career Profile

I am a postdoctoral researcher in the Formal Methods and Verification group at the Université Libre de Bruxelles. My current work focuses on strategy synthesis for partially observable Markov decision processes. Before joining ULB, I was a research fellow in the School of Mathematics and Computer Science at the Indian Institute of Technology Goa. My research interests lie at the intersection of automata theory and formal verification. During my PhD and my subsequent tenure as a research fellow at IIT Goa, I focused on the equivalence and learning of one-counter systems.

Publications

- **Edit Distance of Finite-Valued Transducers** — *Jul 7, 2026*
  Co-authors: Dr. Saina Sunny. — *ICALP 2026 (to appear)*
- **Synthesizing POMDP Policies: Sampling Meets Model-checking via Learning** — *Jul 26, 2026*
  Co-authors: Dr. Debraj Chakraborty, Dr. Anirban Majumdar, Dr. Sayan Mukherjee, Prof. Jean-François Raskin. — *CAV 2026 (to appear)*
- **Scalable Learning of One-Counter Automata via State-Merging Algorithms [Link]** — *Sep 8, 2025*
  Co-authors: Dr. Shibashis Guha, Dr. Anirban Majumdar, Dr. Sreejith A.V. — *FSTTCS 2025*
- **Learning Deterministic One-Counter Automata in Polynomial Time [Link]** — *Mar 7, 2025*
  Co-authors: Dr. Vincent Penelle, Dr. Sreejith A.V. — *LICS 2025*
- **Learning Real-time One-Counter Automata Using Polynomially Many Queries [Link]** — *May 1, 2025*
  Co-authors: Dr. Vincent Penelle, Dr. Sreejith A.V. — *TACAS 2025*
- **Equivalence of Deterministic Weighted Real-time One-Counter Automata [Link]** — *Feb 3, 2025*
  Co-authors: Dr. Vincent Penelle, Dr. Prakash Saivasan, Dr. Sreejith A.V. — *ICLA 2025*
- **Weighted One-Deterministic-Counter Automata [Link]** — *December 12, 2023*
  Co-authors: Dr. Vincent Penelle, Dr. Prakash Saivasan, Dr. Sreejith A.V. — *FSTTCS 2023*
- **CAP: A Cellular Automata Based Fuzzy Classifier [Link]** — *February 26, 2022*
  Co-authors: Dr. Abdul Nizar M — *Materials Today Proceedings*
- **Optical Music Recognition Using Image Processing and Machine Learning [Link]** — *August 11, 2018*
  Co-authors: Rahul Vijayakumar, Aju Tom Kuriakose, Jesmy Sunny, Dr. Ramani Bai V — *IJCSE 2018*
- **Survey on Fuzzy Logic & Fuzzy Classifiers Based on Continuous Cellular Automata** — *August 20, 2016*
  Co-authors: Dr. Abdul Nizar M — *NCTT 2016*

Experience

- **Université Libre de Bruxelles** — *November 2025 to present*
  Postdoctoral Researcher
- **Indian Institute of Technology Goa** — *January 2025 to October 2025*
  Junior Research Fellow — *January 2024 to July 2024*
  February 2018 to December 2018

- **Tata Elxsi, Trivandrum** *January 2017 to January 2018*
  Senior Engineer
- **Central Polytechnic College, Trivandrum** *June 2016 to October 2016*
  Guest Lecturer

Important Talks

- Synthesizing POMDP Policies: Sampling Meets Model-checking via Learning, AQUARIUM 2026 *March 24, 2026*
- Learning Deterministic One-Counter Automata, RP 2025 *October 2, 2025*
- Learning Deterministic One-Counter Automata in Polynomial Time, LICS 2025 *June 24, 2025*
- Learning Real-Time One-Counter Automata Using Polynomially Many Queries, TACAS 2025 **[Talk]** *May 6, 2025*
- Weighted One-Deterministic-Counter Automata (Lightning Talk), ACM ARCS 2025 *Feb 27, 2025*
- Equivalence of Deterministic Weighted Real-time One-Counter Automata, ICLA 2025 *Feb 3, 2025*
- Learning Real-Time One-Counter Automata Using Polynomially Many Queries, RHPL 2024 **[Talk]** *Dec 18, 2024*
- Learning one-counter automata using SAT solver, Highlights 2024 **[Talk]** *Sep 19, 2024*
- Weighted one deterministic-counter automata, FSTTCS 2023 **[Talk]** *July 2023*
- One deterministic-counter automata, Highlights 2023 **[Talk]** *July 2023*
- Weighted one-deterministic-counter automata, FM Update Meeting 2023 **[Talk]** *June 2023*

Other Talks

- Synthesizing POMDP Policies: Sampling Meets Model-checking via Learning, CFV Seminar, ULB, 2026 *March 6, 2026*
- Learning Deterministic One-Counter Automata in Polynomial Time, IIT Bombay *July 18, 2025*
- Learning Real-Time One-Counter Automata Using Polynomially Many Queries, TIFR Mumbai *April 4, 2025*
- Learning One-Counter Automata Using SAT Solver, Université Libre de Bruxelles, Belgium *September 10, 2024*
- Learning One-Counter Automata Using SAT Solver, Université de Mons, Belgium *September 9, 2024*
- Learning One-Counter Automata Using SAT Solver, RWTH Aachen University, Germany *September 6, 2024*
- CAP: A cellular automata-based fuzzy classifier, AIES 2021 *December 2021*
- Optical music recognition using image processing and machine learning, IJCSE 2018 *August 2018*

Community Services

- Sub-reviewer for the International Conference on Concurrency Theory (CONCUR), 2023
- Sub-reviewer for the IARCS Annual Conference on Foundations of Software Technology and Theoretical Computer Science (FSTTCS), 2024.
- Sub-reviewer for the International Conference on Concurrency Theory (CONCUR), 2023
- Reviewed NPTEL transcripts for the course “Theory of Computation” by Prof. Somenath Biswas

Awards and Recognitions

- Received grant from Google for our work on learning one-counter automata — *May 2025*
- Received ACM/IARCS travel grant for attending LICS 2025 — *May 2025*
- Selected for scholarship for the Logic Mentoring Workshop at LICS 2025 — *April 2025*
- Successfully defended my Ph.D. dissertation titled "Learning and Equivalence of one-counter systems" — *April, 2025*
- Awarded with the ETAPS 2025 scholarship for participating in TACAS 2025 — *April 2025*
- Awarded with the ACM/IARCS travel grant for attending TACAS 2025 — *April 2025*
- Received travel grant from ACM India for attending ARCS 2025 — *March 2025*
- Received invitation from ACM India to present our work at ARCS 2025 — *December 2024*
- Received grants from RWTH Aachen University, Germany and University of Antwerp, Belgium for research visits — *September 2024*

Research Visits

- Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR), Mumbai, India — *July 16 to July 22, 2025*
- Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR), Mumbai, India — *March 24 to April 4, 2025*
- University of Antwerp, Belgium — *Sep 9 to 13, 2024*
- RWTH Aachen University, Germany — *Sep 4 to 6, 2024*
- The Institute of Mathematical Sciences, HBNI, India — *June 1 to 30, 2022*
- Chennai Mathematical Institute, Chennai, India — *January 6 to May 30, 2020*

Teaching Assistance

- Embedded Systems Design — *Winter 2025-26*
- Introduction to Computing — *Spring 2020 – 21, Autumn 2023 – 24*
- Randomised Algorithms — *Spring 2022 – 23*
- Software Tools — *Spring 2022 – 23*
- Data Structures and Algorithms — *Autumn 2022 – 23, Summer 2022, Autumn 2021 – 22, Autumn 2020 – 21*
- Automata Theory — *Spring 2020 – 21, Spring 2018 – 19*
- Logic in Computer Science — *Autumn 2019 – 20*
- Advanced Algorithms — *Spring 2018 – 19*

Education

- **Indian Institute of Technology Goa** — *January 2019 to December 2024*
  Ph.D. in Theoretical Computer Science — CPI: 8.45
  - **Chennai Mathematical Institute, Tamil Nadu** — *January 2020 to April 2020*
    Ph.D. Coursework
- **College of Engineering Trivandrum, Kerala** — *August 2014 to April 2016*
  M.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering — CGPA: 9.11
- **Saintgits Engineering College, Kerala** — *July 2010 to April 2014*
  B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering — CGPA: 7.62
- **Don Bosco Higher Secondary School, Kottayam, Kerala** — *2008 to 2010*
  Class 12 — Aggregate: **86.36** %
- **Don Bosco Higher Secondary School, Kottayam, Kerala** — *2007 to 2008*
  Class 10 — CGPA: **10/10**

Other Activities

- Volunteered and contributed towards the successful organisation of FSTTCS 2021 and FSTTCS 2022
- Volunteered in organising Formal Methods Update Meeting 2023
- Volunteered in organising the Indian School on Logic and its Applications 2024
- PG representative in the Senate Students Advisory Committee, IIT Goa from 2019 to 2021
- Member of the evaluation team for the national level technical project exhibition - SRISHTI 2025
- Successfully cleared the UGC NET examination and have met the eligibility criteria for lectureship
- Passed BEC Vantage conducted by the University of Cambridge
- Passed grade 5 vocals with merit conducted by Trinity College London
- Passed grade 3 piano with merit conducted by Trinity College London

Projects

- **CPLUS** *November 2025 to April 2026*

  A tool for strategy synthesis for partially observable Markov decision processes.
  - Tools & technologies used: AALpy, Python
  - This tool is associated with our paper "Synthesizing POMDP Policies: Sampling Meets Model-checking via Jul 26, 2026 Learning" that will appear in CAV 2026. Code: **zenodo.org/records/19850366**

- **OCA-L*** *June 2025 to August 2025*

  A tool for active learning of one-counter automata using RPNI.
  - Tools & technologies used: AALpy, DFAMiner, Python
  - This tool is associated with our paper "Scalable Learning of One-Counter Automata via State-Merging Algorithms " that appeared in FSTTCS 2025. Code: **zenodo.org/records/17310292**

- **MinOCA** *January 2024 to December 2024*

  A tool for active learning of one-counter automata using polynomially many queries
  - Tools & technologies used: DFAMiner, Python
  - This tool is associated with our paper "Learning Real-Time One-Counter Automata Using Polynomially Many Queries" that appeared in TACAS 2025. Code: **zenodo.org/records/14604419**

- **MoES - River Width Extraction Project** *February 2018 to December 2018*

  Web application for MoES for calculating river water discharge from satellite images.
  - Tools & technologies used: Python, Django
  - This work was done as a part of a joint project with Dr. Sreejith A.V (IIT Goa) and Dr. Gaurav Kumar (IISER Bhopal).

- **Skill Center - Tata Elxsi** *January 2017 - February 2018*

  Web application to manage employee profiles of Tata Elxsi.
  - Tools & technologies used: C#, MVC, .NET
  - The application manages skills, project allocation, training, funnel management, performance evaluations, and resume creation. It helps assign projects based on employee skills, plan and track training, search for employees, assess performance, and create resumes.

- **Fuzzy Classifier using Continuous Cellular Automata [Report][Code]** *June 2015 - September 2016*

  Continuous cellular automata-based fuzzy classifier in Java using Weka.
  - Tools & technologies used: Java, Weka
  - This tool is associated with our paper "CAP: A Cellular Automata Based Fuzzy Classifier".
  - Project done as part of Masters degree thesis.

- **Open Image Transcriptor [Report][Code]** *June 2013 - June 2014*

  Image processing tool to recognise musical notes from sheet music and convert it into a MIDI file.
  - Tools & technologies used: Java, Python
  - This tool is associated with our paper "Optical music recognition using image processing and machine learning".
  - Project done as part of Undergraduate project.